CHEATSHEET FROM @DOMBUILDS.AI

The Landed Dollar Sheet

The formulas, example payouts, and checks that show what a subscription really pays you before you set the price.

> The price on your paywall is the buyer's number, and the number that matters is what lands in your account. Apple's terms and tax rates change, so use this to do the math, then confirm your live figures in App Store Connect.

Use it in 5 minutes

1. Write down your price, the VAT rate in your main market, and your Apple rate.
2. Run the payout formula, then the reverse formula with your target payout.
3. Work through the leaks and fix the first one that applies.

THE MATH

01 **Payout formula**

Payout = price / (1 + VAT) x (1 - Apple's rate). Write an example 20% VAT as 0.20. Remove VAT first, because Apple's share is calculated on the price without it.

02 **Reverse formula**

Minimum price = target payout / (1 - Apple's rate) x (1 + VAT). Example: landing $6 at 15% with 20% VAT needs $8.47, so list $8.99 and land $6.37.

03 **Tax on top markets**

Where sales tax is added at checkout, as in the US, skip the VAT step. An example $10 price lands $7.00 at 30% or $8.50 at 15%.

WHAT AN EXAMPLE $10 PRICE LANDS

04 **No VAT in the price**

Base is $10.00. You land $8.50 at 15% or $7.00 at 30%. Use this row for markets where tax is added on top.

05 **Example 19% VAT**

Base is $8.40. You land $7.14 at 15% or $5.88 at 30%. Check the current rate for each market you care about.

06 **Example 20% VAT**

Base is $8.33. You land $7.08 at 15% or $5.83 at 30%. This is the case from the reel, a $1.25 gap per sale.

07 **Example 25% VAT**

Base is $8.00. You land $6.80 at 15% or $5.60 at 30%. The buyer sees the same $10 as in the rows above.

08 **Example 27% VAT**

Base is $7.87. You land $6.69 at 15% or $5.51 at 30%. High VAT markets are where one global price quietly pays least.

WHICH APPLE RATE YOU ARE ON

09 **Small Business Program**

It gives 15% from a subscriber's first day if you qualify, but it is not automatic. The Account Holder must enroll and list any associated developer accounts.

10 **The $1M limit counts proceeds**

Eligibility looks at proceeds across your associated accounts, not buyer prices. Pass $1M during the year and the standard rate returns for future sales that year.

11 **Apply before your first sale**

Do not count on commission already paid being returned. Apply before launch, or today if you are live, then confirm your rate in App Store Connect.

12 **How the one year rule counts**

A subscriber reaches 15% after one year of paid service. Free trial days do not count, and a lapse longer than 60 days resets the count.

13 **The two discounts do not stack**

A year two subscriber on the Small Business Program still costs 15%, not less. The form saves you money on subscribers in their first paid year.

14 **Read the $1,250 example correctly**

It assumes 1,000 example monthly subscribers at $10, 20% VAT, all in their first paid year. Subscribers without VAT in the price gain $1.50 each, and those past a year gain nothing.

LEAKS AFTER APPLE'S CUT

15 **Cost per heavy user**

If your app calls an AI model, subtract the monthly cost of your heaviest realistic user from the payout. Pricing from the average user hides who loses you money.

16 **Free trials**

A trial pays nothing while your AI and server costs keep running. Cap expensive features during the trial, or shorten it if trial users rarely convert.

17 **Refunds**

A refunded sale comes back out of your proceeds. Check your refund line in App Store Connect and subtract your own rate from your forecast.

18 **US tax form for non-US developers**

Complete the US tax form in App Store Connect and claim any treaty rate you qualify for. Otherwise US sales can face withholding of up to 30%.

19 **Payment timing**

Apple pays after its fiscal month closes, generally within 45 days, and only once you reach the payment threshold. Keep enough cash for AI bills in the gap.

20 **Bank currency**

Compare the amount in your Apple payment report with what reaches your bank. A currency conversion spread is a real cost, and a different account currency may reduce it.

21 **Income tax**
Payout is business revenue, not take-home money. Set aside a percentage based on your own country's rules, and ask a local accountant if you are unsure.

PRICING MOVES FOR THIS WEEK

22 **Write your floor number**
Choose the minimum payout per subscriber after AI costs. Every price decision then becomes a simple check: does this market land above the floor or not?

23 **Check proceeds by country**
Open your subscription pricing in App Store Connect and read the proceeds shown for each storefront. Mark every market that lands below your floor.

24 **Override only the weak markets**
Apple can generate prices from one base country, but you can set individual storefronts yourself. Adjust the markets below your floor and leave the rest alone.

25 **Compare annual and monthly on payout**
Example at 20% VAT and 15%: $60 yearly lands $42.50 and $10 monthly lands $7.08. Annual equals six monthly payments, so compare it with how long subscribers actually stay.

26 **Decide on existing subscribers first**
Before raising a price, choose whether current subscribers keep the old one. Larger increases can require their consent, and anyone who does not agree may be lost.

27 **Check web payment rules first**
US rules on linking to outside checkout have shifted through court rulings, so read Apple's current guidelines. Web sales add processor fees and tax work, so compare landed money.

28 **Give Android its own row**

Google Play has separate enrollment, rates, and policy changes. Do not copy Apple's numbers across; run the same formula with the rate shown in your Play Console.

PRICING FOR AN EXAMPLE $6 PAYOUT IN A 20% VAT MARKET

Before: Listing at $7.99 because $6 feels covered. Without enrolling, the payout is $4.66 per sale at 30%.

After: Enrolled at 15%, the reverse formula gives a $8.47 minimum. Listing at $8.99 lands $6.37 per sale.

Next

I share more of the real numbers and decisions behind building apps with AI at @dombuilds.ai, so follow along if this helped.

Follow @dombuilds.ai for the next one.